NavigSA

Product Backlog

User stories, enabler tasks and tasks for the NavigSA project

Project	NavigSA (Navigate SA - Student Application Services)
Team	Marc Kabala, Tanatswa Mabhodha, Nolwazi Zulu, Witcha Francisco
Project period	14 July - 30 October 2026
Backlog size	29 items: 26 user stories and 3 enabler tasks (162 story points)
Source	Trello board NAVIGSA (Latest), list Product Backlog (29 cards)
Last updated	29 October 2026

About this backlog

The Product Backlog is the single list of everything the NavigSA team needed to deliver. Each item is a user story (As a [role], I want [goal], so that [benefit]) or an enabler task that supports the project, with a priority, the members responsible, acceptance criteria and a task checklist. IDs (US-01 to US-29) are the same as on the portfolio website. Priority High maps to Must and Medium to Should (MoSCoW). Story points are relative estimates (Fibonacci scale), not hours.

The Sprints column shows which sprint cards worked on each item. The link is taken from each sprint card's user story and should be confirmed by the team. Sprints 17 and 18 (architecture work) have no matching Product Backlog item. Some sprints are linked to more than one item, based on each card's checklist (for example Sprint 34 delivers dashboard, booking and notification work). Items US-04 and US-06 are not linked to any sprint card. The technology stack in the original plan was later adjusted: the completed website is deployed on Vercel and uses Supabase.

Changes made to the board on 28 and 29 October 2026

On 28 and 29 October 2026 Marc Kabala was added as a member of Sprints 17, 18, 22, 23, 29, 31, 32, 34, 36 and 42 and of five Product Backlog items (Secure Login, Track Application Status, Register as a Service Provider, Submit Reviews and View Testimonials), because he built the backend and frontend. Sprints 29 and 42 previously had no owner. Dates for Sprints 29 to 32 (1 to 4 September 2026) were added; these four cards are one story split into four tasks and were not dated separately before. Trello shows owners in each card's description; it does not hold native member assignments.

Delivery note

US-17, US-18, US-19, US-21, US-22, US-23 and US-25 were built on 29 October 2026 (GitHub commits 1b72b96 and 2cd5ab2), after the sprint period ended on 9 October 2026, so they are not linked to any sprint card. Limits: notifications are in-app only; a suspended account is blocked from creating things but can still sign in; the guides are English only and partly meet the acceptance criteria; a booking, its notification, provider verification and a testimonial submission were clicked through with a real account on 29 October 2026, but reviews, testimonial approval and the landing page testimonials were not.

Backlog overview

ID	Item	Type	Priority	Pts	Sprints
US-01	Coordinate Workspace & Sprint Planning	Enabler	High (Must)	3	14,15
US-02	Define Business Concept	User story	High (Must)	5	1,2, 4, 8
US-03	Conduct Community & Market Research	User story	High (Must)	5	5-7
US-04	Feasibility & Business Planning	User story	High (Must)	5	Not planned in a sprint
US-05	Discover NavigSA Through Marketing	User story	Medium (Should)	5	15, 20
US-06	Build Strategic Partnerships	User story	Medium (Should)	8	Not planned in a sprint
US-07	Present Project Progress	Enabler	High (Must)	3	3, 15, 38
US-08	Complete Final Academic Documentation	Enabler	High (Must)	5	14, 16, 50
US-09	Platform Design (UI/UX)	User story	High (Must)	8	9-13

ID	Item	Type	Priority	Pts	Sprints
US-10	Create Student Account	User story	High (Must)	5	22
US-11	Secure Login	User story	High (Must)	5	25
US-12	Manage Student Profile	User story	High (Must)	3	33
US-13	Browse Available Services	User story	High (Must)	3	24
US-14	Upload Verification Documents	User story	High (Must)	8	39
US-15	View Student Dashboard	User story	High (Must)	8	33-35
US-16	Track Application Status	User story	High (Must)	5	36
US-17	Book a NavigSA Service	User story	High (Must)	8	34, 39
US-18	Receive Notifications and Reminders	User story	Medium (Should)	5	34
US-19	Register as a Service Provider	User story	High (Must)	5	23
US-20	Become a Verified Service Provider	User story	High (Must)	5	23, 26
US-21	Administrator Manages Users	User story	High (Must)	8	39
US-22	Submit Reviews	User story	Medium (Should)	3	24, 27
US-23	View Testimonials	User story	Medium (Should)	2	24, 27
US-24	Access Multilingual Content	User story	Medium (Should)	8	46,47
US-25	Learn Through Educational Content	User story	Medium (Should)	5	48
US-26	Protect Student Information (Operations & Compliance)	User story	High (Must)	8	19, 43-45
US-27	Use a Reliable Platform (Testing & Quality Assurance)	User story	High (Must)	8	37, 39-42, 51,52
US-28	Access the Live NavigSA Platform (Deployment & Launch)	User story	High (Must)	5	49
US-29	Store My Information Securely (Backend & Database)	User story	High (Must)	8	21, 28-32

Backlog items in detail

US-01 Coordinate Workspace & Sprint Planning

Enabler | Priority: High (Must) | 3 points | Sprints: 14,15

Members: Marc Kabala, Tanatswa Mabhodha, Witcha Francisco, Nolwazi Zulu

Enabler statement: To collaborate effectively and deliver the project, the team will set up a shared project workspace and sprint plan. Set up the project environment, assign responsibilities, define communication channels, and prepare Scrum artefacts before development begins.

Acceptance criteria

• The Trello board has a Product Backlog list and one list per sprint week, and every member can open it.
• Each member's role and responsibilities are written down in the team charter.
• The team has agreed on communication channels and meeting times, and recorded them.

Tasks

[x] Create the Trello board with Product Backlog and Sprint Week lists
[x] Invite all four team members and assign roles
[x] Agree on communication channels and the stand-up schedule
[x] Set up the shared GitHub repository and document storage
[x] Write a Definition of Done for the team

US-02 Define Business Concept

User story | Priority: High (Must) | 5 points | Sprints: 1,2, 4, 8

Members: Marc Kabala, Tanatswa Mabhodha, Witcha Francisco, Nolwazi Zulu

User story: As an international student, I want one trusted platform that provides all the services I need for studying in South Africa so that I don't have to search multiple websites.

Acceptance criteria

• The problem statement, the solution and the target beneficiaries are documented.
• The core services are listed: SAQA evaluation, visa guidance, university applications and accommodation.
• The value proposition and trust factors have been presented to the supervisor and the feedback recorded.

Tasks

[x] Write the problem statement and identify the target beneficiaries
[x] Define the list of NavigSA services
[x] Draft the value proposition and trust factors, with references
[x] Prepare and deliver the business concept presentation
[x] Turn supervisor feedback into backlog changes

US-03 Conduct Community & Market Research

User story | Priority: High (Must) | 5 points | Sprints: 5-7

Members: Marc Kabala, Tanatswa Mabhodha, Witcha Francisco, Nolwazi Zulu

User story: As an international student, I want NavigSA to understand my challenges so that the services offered solve my real problems.

Acceptance criteria

• Interviews with international students and service providers have been completed and summarised.
• The identified problems are ranked by how often they happen, how urgent they are and how important they are.
• There is evidence of whether students would pay for a solution.

Tasks

[x] Draft the interview questions
[x] Interview international students and relevant service providers
[x] Analyse the findings and rank the problems
[x] Build the customer profile (needs, where to reach them, when they need help)
[x] Validate problem urgency and willingness to pay

US-04 Feasibility & Business Planning

User story | Priority: High (Must) | 5 points | Sprints: not planned in a sprint
Members: Marc Kabala, Tanatswa Mabhodha, Witcha Francisco, Nolwazi Zulu

User story: As an international student, I want affordable service packages so that I can choose support that fits my budget.

Acceptance criteria
• Service packages are defined, each with a price and what it includes.
• Cost and revenue projections show whether the business is viable.
• The feasibility study is complete and has a clear conclusion.

Tasks
[x] Research competitor and agent pricing
[x] Define the service packages and prices
[x] Build the cost and revenue projection
[x] Write the feasibility study

US-05 Discover NavigSA Through Marketing

User story | Priority: Medium (Should) | 5 points | Sprints: 15, 20
Members: Marc Kabala, Tanatswa Mabhodha, Witcha Francisco, Nolwazi Zulu

User story: As a prospective international student, I want to discover NavigSA through trusted online platforms so that I can learn about the services available before starting my application.

Acceptance criteria
• The brand guide (logo, colours, fonts, tone) is used on the website and on every marketing post.
• NavigSA social media pages are live and linked from the website.
• Enquiries from marketing channels are recorded so that we can see which channels work.

Tasks
[x] Create and finalise the NavigSA brand guide
[x] Set up the social media accounts
[x] Plan a content calendar
[x] Share content in international student communities
[x] Track enquiries by source

US-06 Build Strategic Partnerships

User story | Priority: Medium (Should) | 8 points | Sprints: not planned in a sprint
Members: Marc Kabala, Tanatswa Mabhodha, Witcha Francisco, Nolwazi Zulu

User story: As an international student, I want NavigSA to partner with trusted organisations so that I can access reliable services from verified providers.

Acceptance criteria
• A shortlist of target partners (institutions, accommodation providers, agents) is documented.
• The outreach status of each partner is recorded.
• Partners that have agreed appear on the website, with their permission.

Tasks
[x] Identify the target partner organisations
[x] Write a partnership proposal
[x] Contact partners and log their responses
[x] Add the confirmed partners to the website

US-07 Present Project Progress

Enabler | Priority: High (Must) | 3 points | Sprints: 3, 15, 38
Members: Marc Kabala, Tanatswa Mabhodha, Witcha Francisco, Nolwazi Zulu

Enabler statement: To get feedback and show that the project is meeting its objectives, the team will present its progress to the project supervisor at each milestone.

Acceptance criteria
• Each milestone presentation is delivered on its scheduled date.
• Each presentation shows working results (a prototype, the backend or the live site), not only slides.
• The supervisor's feedback is added to the backlog as new or updated cards.

Tasks
[x] Prepare the slides and the demo
[x] Rehearse as a team
[x] Deliver the presentation
[x] Log the feedback on Trello

US-08 Complete Final Academic Documentation

Enabler | Priority: High (Must) | 5 points | Sprints: 14, 16, 50
Members: Marc Kabala, Tanatswa Mabhodha, Witcha Francisco, Nolwazi Zulu

Enabler statement: To meet all WIL requirements, the team will compile and submit complete, well-structured project documentation.

Acceptance criteria
• All monthly project reports have been submitted on time.
• The sprint documentation and the agile logbook are complete and up to date.
• The Trello board shows the true final status of every card.

Tasks
[x] Complete the monthly project reports
[x] Keep the sprint boards and logbook up to date
[x] Compile the WIL documentation
[x] Submit the documentation and check that it was received

US-09 Platform Design (UI/UX)

User story | Priority: High (Must) | 8 points | Sprints: 9-13
Members: Marc Kabala, Nolwazi Zulu

User story: As an international student, I want an attractive and easy-to-use website so that I can quickly understand NavigSA's services.

Acceptance criteria
• Wireframes exist for the home, services, registration, dashboard and provider onboarding pages.
• The clickable prototype uses the brand guide and works on mobile and desktop.
• The prototype has been reviewed by the team and the supervisor, and the changes recorded.

Tasks
[x] Draw the sitemap and the main user flows
[x] Design the student registration and verification screens
[x] Design the service provider onboarding screens
[x] Design the multilingual content interface
[x] Define the website and technical structure
[x] Present the prototype for review

US-10 Create Student Account

User story | Priority: High (Must) | 5 points | Sprints: 22
Members: Marc Kabala, Witcha Francisco

User story: As an international student, I want to create a NavigSA account so that I can access personalised services.

Acceptance criteria
• Given valid details, when I submit the registration form, my account is created and a confirmation is shown.
• If my email address is already registered, the form says so and does not create a second account.
• Required fields are checked before submission, and the password is stored only as a hash.

Tasks
[x] Build the registration form
[x] Add client-side and server-side validation
[x] Create the registration API endpoint
[x] Hash passwords and save the student record
[x] Test valid, duplicate and invalid sign-ups

US-11 Secure Login

User story | Priority: High (Must) | 5 points | Sprints: 25
Members: Marc Kabala, Tanatswa Mabhodha, Nolwazi Zulu

User story: As an international student, I want to log into my account securely so that I can access my personal dashboard.

Acceptance criteria
• Given correct credentials, when I log in, I am taken to my dashboard.
• Given wrong credentials, I see a general error that does not say which field was wrong.
• Repeated failed attempts are slowed down or blocked, and logging out ends my session.

Tasks
[x] Build the login form
[x] Create the authentication endpoint and session or token handling
[x] Add a limit on failed login attempts
[x] Add logout
[x] Test successful, failed and locked-out logins

US-12 Manage Student Profile

User story | Priority: High (Must) | 3 points | Sprints: 33
Members: Marc Kabala, Witcha Francisco

User story: As an international student, I want to update my personal profile so that my information stays accurate throughout my application journey.

Acceptance criteria
• I can view my profile details.
• I can edit and save my details, and invalid values are rejected with a clear message.
• The saved changes show on my dashboard straight away.

Tasks
[x] Build the profile page
[x] Create the profile update endpoint
[x] Add validation
[x] Test viewing and editing the profile

US-13 Browse Available Services

User story | Priority: High (Must) | 3 points | Sprints: 24
Members: Tanatswa Mabhodha, Witcha Francisco

User story: As an international student, I want to browse all available NavigSA services so that I can decide which service best suits my needs.

Acceptance criteria
• The services page lists every service with a short description and its price.
• Each service has a detail view and a button to book it.
• The page is easy to use on a mobile phone.

Tasks
[x] Define the service data (name, description, price, category)
[x] Build the services listing page
[x] Build the service detail view
[x] Link each service to booking
[x] Test the layout on mobile and desktop

US-14 Upload Verification Documents

User story | Priority: High (Must) | 8 points | Sprints: 39
Members: Marc Kabala, Tanatswa Mabhodha, Witcha Francisco

User story: As an international student, I want to upload my academic and identity documents securely so that my application can be verified.

Acceptance criteria
• I can upload PDF, JPG or PNG files up to the set size limit. Other files are rejected with a clear message.
• Only I and the administrator can open my documents.
• After uploading, each document shows the status "Pending review".

Tasks
[x] Build the upload screen
[x] Validate file type and size
[x] Store files in private storage
[x] Restrict access to the owner and the administrator
[x] Show the document status on the dashboard
[x] Test valid and invalid uploads and the access rules

US-15 View Student Dashboard

User story | Priority: High (Must) | 8 points | Sprints: 33-35
Members: Marc Kabala, Tanatswa Mabhodha

User story: As an international student, I want to view my dashboard so that I can access all my information and services from one place.

Acceptance criteria
• The dashboard shows my profile summary, application status, bookings, notifications and uploaded documents.
• The data comes from the backend and is up to date when the page loads.
• Only I can see my dashboard. Anyone who is not logged in is sent to the login page.

Tasks
[x] Build the dashboard layout
[x] Add the bookings, appointments and notifications panels
[x] Connect the dashboard to the backend APIs
[x] Protect the route so that only logged-in users can open it
[x] Test with real account data

US-16 Track Application Status

User story | Priority: High (Must) | 5 points | Sprints: 36
Members: Marc Kabala, Witcha Francisco, Nolwazi Zulu

User story: As an international student, I want to track my application progress so that I always know what stage my application is in.

Acceptance criteria
• Each application shows one of these statuses: Submitted, Under review, Action required or Approved.
• When the administrator changes a status, my dashboard shows the change and I am notified.
• I can see the history of status changes with dates.

Tasks
[x] Define the status values and the data model
[x] Let the administrator update a status
[x] Show a status timeline to the student
[x] Send a notification when the status changes
[x] Test every status change

US-17 Book a NavigSA Service

User story | Priority: High (Must) | 8 points | Sprints: 34, 39
Members: Marc Kabala, Tanatswa Mabhodha

User story: As an international student, I want to book a NavigSA service so that I can receive assistance with my study journey.

Acceptance criteria
• I can choose a service and a date and time, then submit a booking.
• Dates in the past cannot be selected.
• I receive a confirmation, and the booking appears on my dashboard.

Tasks
[x] Build the booking form
[x] Create the booking API and validation
[x] Send a booking confirmation
[x] Show bookings on the dashboard
[x] Test valid and invalid bookings

US-18 Receive Notifications and Reminders

User story | Priority: Medium (Should) | 5 points | Sprints: 34
Members: Marc Kabala, Tanatswa Mabhodha, Witcha Francisco, Nolwazi Zulu

User story: As an international student, I want to receive reminders and notifications so that I never miss important application deadlines or updates.

Acceptance criteria
• I am notified when my application status changes or when a booking is confirmed.
• I receive a reminder before an upcoming deadline or appointment.
• I can mark notifications as read.

Tasks
[x] Create the notification data model
[x] Add the triggers for status changes, bookings and deadlines
[x] Build the in-app notification list
[x] Add email delivery
[x] Test each trigger

US-19 Register as a Service Provider

User story | Priority: High (Must) | 5 points | Sprints: 23
Members: Marc Kabala, Witcha Francisco, Nolwazi Zulu

User story: As a service provider, I want to register on NavigSA so that I can offer my services to international students.

Acceptance criteria
• I can register with my business details and upload my accreditation documents.
• After registering, my account status is "Pending verification".
• My services are not shown to students until I am verified.

Tasks
[x] Build the provider onboarding form
[x] Add the accreditation document upload
[x] Create the provider registration API
[x] Hide unverified providers from the public pages
[x] Test the registration flow

US-20 Become a Verified Service Provider

User story | Priority: High (Must) | 5 points | Sprints: 23, 26

Members: Marc Kabala, Tanatswa Mabhodha, Witcha Francisco, Nolwazi Zulu

User story: As a service provider, I want to become verified so that students trust the services I provide.

Acceptance criteria

• The verification criteria are documented.
• The administrator can approve or reject a provider and must give a reason for a rejection.
• Approved providers show a "Verified" badge, and every provider is notified of the decision.

Tasks

[x] Define the verification requirements
[x] Build the administrator review screen
[x] Add the "Verified" badge to provider listings
[x] Notify providers of the outcome
[x] Test approval and rejection

US-21 Administrator Manages Users

User story | Priority: High (Must) | 8 points | Sprints: 39

Members: Marc Kabala

User story: As an administrator, I want to manage students and service providers so that I can maintain a secure and trusted platform.

Acceptance criteria

• The administrator can search and view all students and providers.
• The administrator can suspend and reactivate an account.
• Only users with the admin role can open these pages, and every admin action is logged.

Tasks

[x] Add the admin role and its access control
[x] Build the user list with search
[x] Add suspend and reactivate actions
[x] Record admin actions in an audit log
[x] Test that non-admin users cannot access the pages

US-22 Submit Reviews

User story | Priority: Medium (Should) | 3 points | Sprints: 24, 27

Members: Marc Kabala, Nolwazi Zulu

User story: As an international student, I want to leave a review after receiving a service so that I can share my experience with other students.

Acceptance criteria

• Only a student with a completed booking can review that service.
• A review has a rating from 1 to 5 and a comment, and there is one review per booking.
• Reviews follow the agreed review rules and can be removed by the administrator if they are abusive.

Tasks

[x] Define the review and refund rules
[x] Build the review form
[x] Check review eligibility in the API
[x] Add admin moderation
[x] Show reviews on the service pages

US-23 View Testimonials

User story | Priority: Medium (Should) | 2 points | Sprints: 24, 27

Members: Marc Kabala, Witcha Francisco

User story: As an international student, I want to read testimonials from previous users so that I can make informed decisions before using NavigSA.

Acceptance criteria

• The home page shows testimonials from verified users only.
• The administrator approves each testimonial before it is published.
• A testimonial shows the user's name and country only if they have given consent.

Tasks

[x] Build the testimonials section
[x] Add the admin approval step
[x] Record user consent
[x] Test publishing and hiding testimonials

US-24 Access Multilingual Content

User story | Priority: Medium (Should) | 8 points | Sprints: 46,47
Members: Tanatswa Mabhodha, Witcha Francisco

User story: As a French- or Portuguese-speaking international student, I want to read information in my preferred language so that I clearly understand every step of the application process.

Acceptance criteria
• A language switcher offers English, French and Portuguese, and remembers my choice.
• All main pages and messages are translated.
• A fluent speaker has reviewed the translations for accuracy.

Tasks
[x] Design the language switcher
[x] Set up translation files
[x] Translate the page content into French and Portuguese
[x] Have a fluent speaker review the translations
[x] Test every page in each language

US-25 Learn Through Educational Content

User story | Priority: Medium (Should) | 5 points | Sprints: 48
Members: Tanatswa Mabhodha, Witcha Francisco

User story: As an international student, I want access to educational guides and videos so that I understand the SAQA, visa, university application, and accommodation processes before I begin my journey.

Acceptance criteria
• There are guides for SAQA evaluation, study visas, university applications and accommodation.
• Each guide is available in English, French and Portuguese.
• Each guide lists its official sources and the date it was last reviewed.

Tasks
[x] Research the official processes and sources
[x] Write the guides
[x] Produce the short explainer videos
[x] Translate the guides
[x] Publish the guides on the platform

US-26 Protect Student Information (Operations & Compliance)

User story | Priority: High (Must) | 8 points | Sprints: 19, 43-45
Members: Marc Kabala, Tanatswa Mabhodha, Witcha Francisco

User story: As an international student, I want my personal information and documents to be stored securely so that my privacy is protected and I can trust NavigSA.

Acceptance criteria
• A privacy policy that follows the Protection of Personal Information Act (POPIA) is published on the site.
• The site uses HTTPS, passwords are hashed and documents can only be opened by authorised users.
• The procedures for handling data and responding to security incidents are documented.

Tasks
[x] Design the platform's security structure
[x] Design and implement the database and models
[x] Prepare secure backend APIs
[x] Review the POPIA, privacy and compliance requirements
[x] Review the technical security measures
[x] Document the operational and security procedures

US-27 Use a Reliable Platform (Testing & Quality Assurance)

User story | Priority: High (Must) | 8 points | Sprints: 37, 39-42, 51,52
Members: Marc Kabala, Tanatswa Mabhodha, Witcha Francisco, Nolwazi Zulu

User story: As an international student, I want the NavigSA platform to work reliably so that I can complete my applications without errors or interruptions.

Acceptance criteria
• Test cases based on the acceptance criteria of every Must story have been run.
• Every defect is logged, and all critical defects are fixed before launch.
• User acceptance testing has been done with sample users and their feedback recorded.

Tasks
[x] Write the test plan and test cases
[x] Test the main student features
[x] Test the frontend and backend working together
[x] Run user acceptance testing with sample users
[x] Fix the defects found
[x] Run a final test on the live site

US-28 Access the Live NavigSA Platform (Deployment & Launch)

User story | Priority: High (Must) | 5 points | Sprints: 49
Members: Marc Kabala, Tanatswa Mabhodha, Witcha Francisco, Nolwazi Zulu

User story: As an international student, I want the NavigSA platform to be available online so that I can access its services from anywhere.

Acceptance criteria
• The website and the backend are live on a public HTTPS address.
• A smoke test of registration, login and the dashboard passes after every deployment.
• The website link has been submitted as required.

Tasks
[x] Deploy the backend and fix any deployment issues
[x] Deploy the frontend
[x] Configure the domain and HTTPS
[x] Run the smoke test
[x] Submit the website link

US-29 Store My Information Securely (Backend & Database)

User story | Priority: High (Must) | 8 points | Sprints: 21, 28-32
Members: Marc Kabala, Tanatswa Mabhodha, Witcha Francisco, Nolwazi Zulu

User story: As an international student, I want my information to be stored securely so that I can safely use NavigSA's services. One story delivered through four tasks across Sprints 29-32 (Sprint Week 8): backend setup, database design, database models and backend APIs.

Acceptance criteria
• Student and provider data is saved in the database and is still there after the server restarts.
• Passwords are stored only as hashes, and every API call that reads or writes personal data requires a logged-in user.
• The backend APIs return clear errors for invalid or missing data and have been tested.

Tasks
[x] Task 1 (Sprint 29): Set up the backend project
[x] Task 2 (Sprint 30): Design the database
[x] Task 3 (Sprint 31): Implement the database models
[x] Task 4 (Sprint 32): Prepare the backend APIs